sayplay

Brand & UI guidelines for developers

Everything needed to build Sayplay on mobile and desktop:
tokens, type, color, components, game HUD, motion and copy.
Version 1.0.

Say it. Play it.



02 Six rules that make it Sayplay

If a screen breaks one of these, it stops looking like Sayplay and starts looking like a template.

1

Ink outlines everything

Every interactive surface has a 2.5px ink border. It keeps the UI readable on top of any generated 3D world.

2

Shadows are hard, never blurred

Depth comes from a solid ink offset (3, 5 or 7px). No blur, no opacity, no gradients.

3

Pressing sinks the button

On press, a button moves into its own shadow. This is the core tactile moment of the brand.

4

Tilt is a treat

Only idea cards, world tags and celebration badges may rotate, by 1.5 to 6 degrees. Buttons, inputs and text never tilt.

5

One loud colour per screen

Tomato is reserved for the single primary action. Sun supports it. Everything else is cream, paper and ink.

6

Plain, cheeky words

Short sentences, real verbs, a little attitude. The UI never apologises and never sounds like a robot.

03 Logo



logo-lockup.svg · on cream / paper



logo-lockup-on-dark.svg · on ink



logo-lockup.svg · on sun



mono-ink · one-colour contexts



mono-ink · on tomato (never full colour)



mark.svg · app icon

Clear space & size

Keep clear space of at least half the mark's height on every side. Minimum lockup height: 24px on screen. Below 24px, use the mark alone (min. 16px).

Never

Retype the wordmark in a font (use the SVG, it is outlined). Recolour the bubble anything other than tomato. Add shadows, gradients or rotation to the logo. Place the full-colour logo on tomato or photos.

04 Colour

#FFF3DF	#FFFFFF	#1F1A17	#FF5A36	#FFC530
Aa 15.7:1	Aa 17.2:1	Aa 15.7:1	Aa 5.6:1	Aa 10.9:1
cream	**paper**	**ink**	**tomato**	**sun**
App background (canvas)	Surfaces: inputs, cards, sheets, HUD pills	Primary text, all outlines, hard shadows, icons	Primary action, brand accent, danger-in-game	Secondary accent: mic, timer, rewards, highlights

#FFD66B	#9BE3B0	#8FD3FF	#FFB8C8	#5A524B	#6E655D	#FFE7C2	#C8231B	#1E7A43
Aa 12.4:1	Aa 11.5:1	Aa 10.6:1	Aa 10.6:1	Aa 7.0:1	Aa 5.2:1	Aa 14.3:1	Aa 5.2:1	Aa 4.9:1
sun-soft	**mint**	**sky**	**bubblegum**	**ink-soft**	**ink-faint**	**cream-deep**	**alarm**	**grass**
Idea card (sun variant)	Idea card, success surface	Idea card, info surface, default game sky	Idea card only	Secondary text, helper text	Placeholder text, disabled labels	Pressed/hover fill on cream, secondary chips	Error text and icons (form errors, failed generation)	Success text and icons



Approximate share of a typical screen. The palette contains no purple or violet. The -deep shades (tomato-deep, sun-deep, mint-deep, sky-deep) are for illustration shading only, never behind text.

05 Contrast pairings

	Pair	Ratio	WCAG	Use
Aa	ink on cream	**15.71:1**	AA	All text
Aa	ink on paper	**17.24:1**	AA	All text
Aa	ink-soft on cream	**6.98:1**	AA	Secondary text
Aa	ink-faint on paper	**5.70:1**	AA	Placeholder only
Aa	ink on tomato	**5.55:1**	AA	Primary button label
Aa	ink on sun	**10.90:1**	AA	Labels on sun
Aa	ink on mint	**11.50:1**	AA	Idea card text
Aa	ink on sky	**10.61:1**	AA	Idea card text
Aa	alarm on paper	**5.66:1**	AA	Error message
Aa	grass on cream	**4.88:1**	AA	Success message
Aa	cream on ink	**15.71:1**	AA	Active tab, status pill

Forbidden pairs

- **paper on tomato · 3.1:1**
- **tomato on cream · 2.8:1**
- **sun on paper · 1.6:1**
- **ink-faint on cream-deep · 4.7:1**

White or cream text on tomato fails contrast. Every coloured button uses ink text. Tomato and sun are fills, never text colours.

06 Typefaces

Aa

Bricolage Grotesque

Display: headlines, buttons, HUD numbers, stats. Always weight 800, optical size auto. Variable, OFL.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 !?&.,:

Aa

Figtree

Body & UI: paragraphs, inputs, labels, captions, tab labels. Weights 500, 600, 700, 800. Variable, OFL.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 !?&.,:

Numbers in the HUD, timers and stats use tabular figures (`font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums`) so they do not jitter while counting. Sentence case everywhere. No all-caps labels, no letter-spaced eyebrows.

07 Type scale

Token	Sample	Size mobile / desktop	Weight	Line height	Tracking
`display-xl`	**Say it.**	48 / 72	800	1.0	-0.04em
`display-l`	**What do you want to play?**	40 / 56	800	1.0	-0.035em
`display-m`	**You did it!**	32 / 40	800	1.05	-0.03em
`title-l`	**Need an idea?**	24 / 28	800	1.15	-0.02em
`title-m`	**Grab one.**	19 / 20	800	1.2	-0.01em
`button-l`	**Make it!**	22 / 22	800	1.0	-0.02em
`button-m`	**Play again**	16 / 16	800	1.0	0em
`body-l`	A fox steals eggs from a farm	18 / 19	600	1.35	0em
`body`	All 5 eggs stolen. The dog never saw you.	16 / 16	500	1.45	0em
`body-s`	Surprise me	14 / 14	600	1.4	0em
`label`	**Say it in one sentence**	13 / 13	700	1.25	0em
`caption`	**times caught**	12 / 12	700	1.3	0.01em
`hud-num`	**14.2s**	18 / 20	800	1.0	-0.01em

08 Spacing, shape & depth

Spacing · 4px base

	`space-0.5`	2px
	`space-1`	4px
	`space-2`	8px
	`space-3`	12px
	`space-4`	16px
	`space-5`	20px
	`space-6`	24px
	`space-8`	32px
	`space-10`	40px
	`space-12`	48px
	`space-16`	64px
	`space-20`	80px

Radius



`radius-xs` 8 · `radius-sm` 12 · `radius-md` 16 · `radius-lg` 20 · `radius-xl` 24



`radius-2xl` 32 · `radius-pill` pill

Bigger things get bigger radii: pill for chips & HUD, md for small buttons, lg for primary buttons & cards, xl for inputs & tab bar, 2xl for sheets.

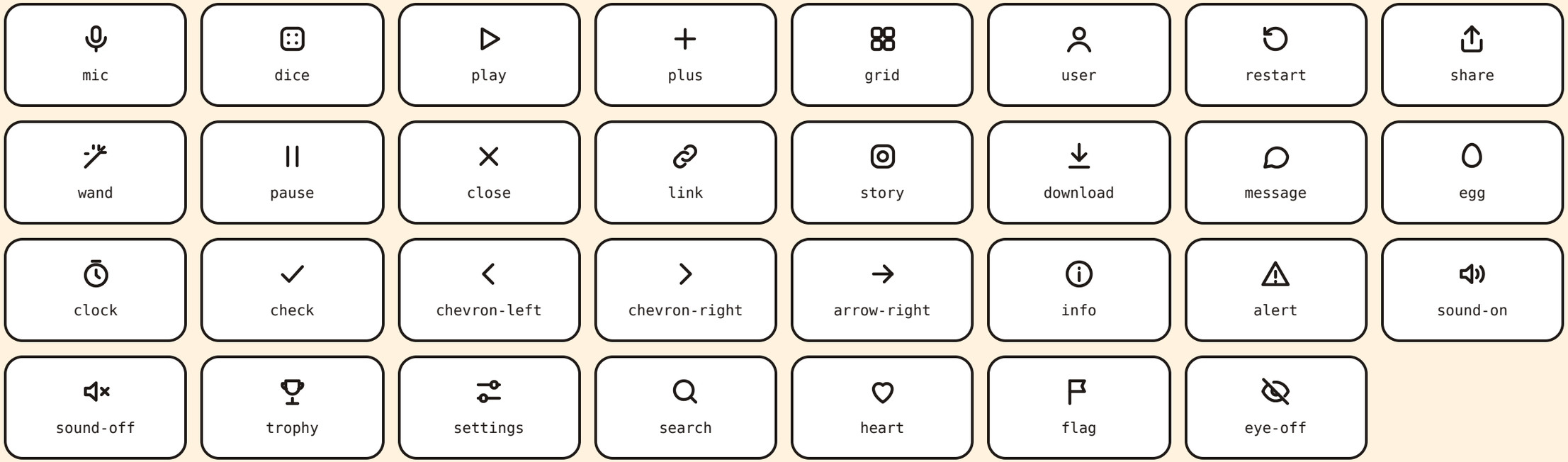
Border & shadow



`shadow-none` · `shadow-sm` · `shadow-md` · `shadow-lg`

Border: 2px chips & small, 2.5px default, 3px sheets & HUD over busy worlds. Shadow: sm for 44–52px controls, md for primary buttons & inputs, lg only for focused input.

09 Icons



24×24 grid, 2.2px stroke, round caps and joins, `currentColor`. Sizes: 24px default, 18px inside chips, 26px in 60px+ buttons. Individual SVGs in `/icons`, all symbols in `icons/sprite.svg` (`<use href="#sp-mic">`). Never use emoji as icons.

10 Buttons

Make it!

`.sp-btn--primary`

Make it!

`:active / .is-pressed`

Play again

`.sp-btn--secondary`

Make it!

`:disabled`

Remix it

`.sp-btn--m`

Surprise me

`.sp-btn--s`

`.sp-btn--icon.sp-btn--sun`

`--icon.--l`

Copy link

`.sp-btn--link`

Size	Height	Radius	Shadow	Font	Press	Use
L (default)	**62**	lg 20	md	button-l, Bricolage 22	translate 5,5	One primary action per screen
M	**52**	md 16	sm	button-m, Figtree 16/800	translate 3,3	Secondary pairs (Play again / Remix)
S	**44**	pill	none	body-s 700	scale .96	Inline helpers inside cards
Icon	**52 / 62**	pill	sm	icon 24 / 26	translate 3,3	Mic, restart, share, pause. Always aria-label

11 Prompt, chips, idea cards & stats

Say it in one sentence

A fox steals eggs while the farmer's dog chases it…

Surprise me

0/140

`.sp-prompt · focus-within lifts to shadow-lg`

Say it in one sentence

a game

⚠ Add who you are and what you're doing, like "a cat stealing fish".

`.sp-prompt.is-error + .sp-field-error`

Chase | Collect | Survive | Race

`.sp-chip / .is-selected`

Hamster escapes a supermarket Roomba

Grab five glowing mushrooms

Carry a wobbly cake to the party

The floor is lava, for 60 seconds

`.sp-idea--mint | --sun | --sky | --gum + .sp-tilt-l / -r (alternate)`

5/5	0	1.1s
eggs	times caught	your best

`.sp-stat`

12 Navigation & feedback

sayplay JS

`.sp-appbar`

Make | Play | My games | Me

`.sp-tabbar · floating, 12px from edges, respects safe area`

Quick version · the full-detail one is on its way

`.sp-status · replaces blocking "AI is busy" dialogs`

Link copied. Go dare someone.

Couldn't build that. Try fewer rules.

`.sp-toast / .sp-toast--error`

Change one thing

What should change?

Make the dog slower

Make it harder | Add a twist | Swap the enemy

Remix it

`.sp-sheet · 3px top border, 2xl radius`

- Reading your idea
- Building the world
- Setting the rules
- Painting it in

`.sp-steps · generation progress`

13 Game HUD

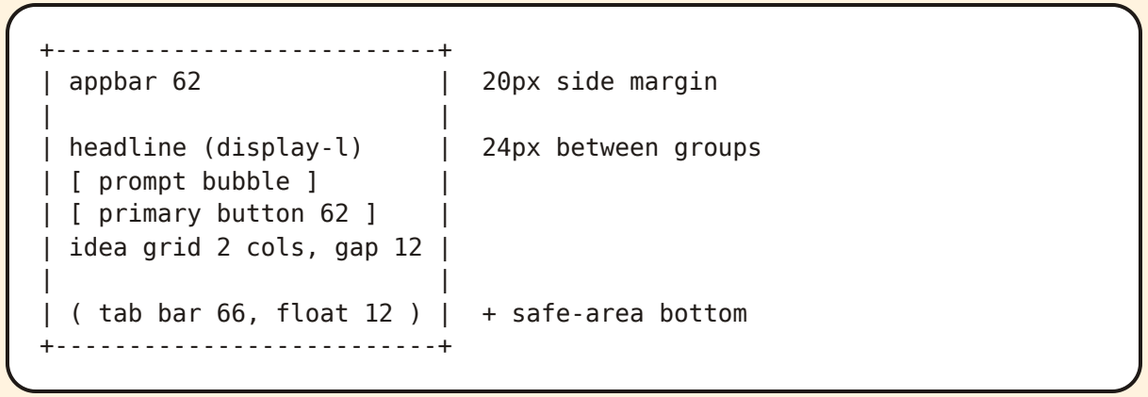


HUD rules

- HUD surfaces are always opaque paper or sun with an ink border. Never glass, blur or transparency: generated worlds can be any colour.
- Top-left: progress (what to collect). Top-right: time and pause. Bottom: restart, remix, share. Nothing in the middle third.
- Progress is shown as the actual objects (eggs), filled vs. dashed, plus a count.
- World tags follow a 3D object (screen-projected every frame, clamped 16px inside the safe area). Tomato = threat, sun = goal. Max 3 visible.
- Generation state lives in a small status pill, never a blocking dialog.
- Minimum 50px hit area for every HUD control. Respect safe-area insets.
- Objective line appears for 4s at start, then collapses into the progress pill.

14 Layout & breakpoints

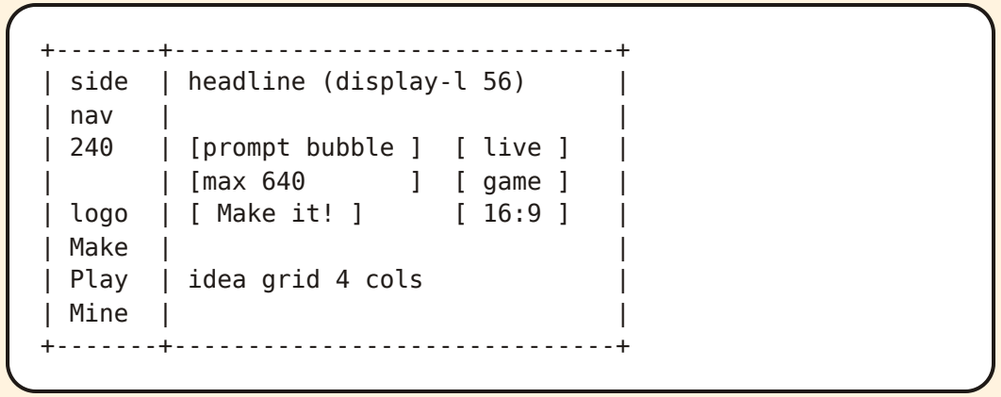
Mobile (0–599px)



Tablet (600–1023px)

Same single column, max content width 560px, centred. Idea grid goes to 3 columns.

Desktop (1024px+)



- Tab bar becomes a 240px left rail with the same items and active style.
- Content max width 1200px, 12-column grid, 24px gutters, 48px outer margin.
- Game plays in a 16:9 stage (max 1280×720), HUD scales with the stage, not the window.
- Keyboard: Enter submits prompt, Space pauses, R restarts, Esc closes sheets. Hover = shadow grows sm→md, press still sinks.

15 Motion & voice

Motion

`duration-press`	**90ms**	Button sink, toggles
`duration-quick`	**160ms**	Hover, focus lift, chips
`duration-base`	**240ms**	Sheets, toasts, screen transitions
`duration-celebrate`	**420ms**	Egg collected, win badge, stars
`ease-standard`	`cubic-bezier(0.2, 0.8, 0.2, 1)` · default for everything	
`ease-pop`	`cubic-bezier(0.34, 1.56, 0.64, 1)` · overshoot for rewards and idea cards only	
`ease-exit`	`cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 1, 1)` · elements leaving the screen	

One celebration per moment. Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`: all durations drop to 0 and pulses stop.

Voice in the UI

Say	Not
Make it!	Generate / Submit
Quick version · the full-detail one is on its way	The AI is busy right now
Couldn't build that. Try fewer rules.	Oops! Something went wrong 😢
Change one thing	Edit prompt parameters
Dare a friend to beat it	Share to social media
You did it!	Level complete. Congratulations!

Sentence case, short, second person, one joke max per screen. Errors say what happened and what to do next.